

ASK A DOCTOR

Will having an orgasm cause me to go into labor? In a pregnancy without problems, an orgasm will not cause [premature labor](#), and at full term orgasm will only cause the onset of labor if it's going to happen anyway. If you have had any signs of premature labor, or vaginal bleeding, you'll be advised to avoid sexual intercourse. This is because the hormone oxytocin increases during sexual arousal, and oxytocin causes the muscles of the uterus to contract. Orgasm may increase [Braxton Hicks contractions](#). You should also avoid sexual intercourse if your water has broken, due to the risk of infection.

If you've gone past your due date and your body is ready to go into labor, sexual intercourse may help things start for two reasons: the prostaglandins in semen help the cervix soften at this stage of pregnancy, and the contractions stimulated by orgasm are more likely to develop into early labor contractions.